

"Feedback That Builds" - Branching Scenario

SCENARIO CHARTER

Problem Statement:

Maya needs to give feedback to her colleague Jordan about a presentation that went poorly, but she's worried about damaging their working relationship and wants to communicate respectfully across their different communication styles.

Learning Objective:

By the end of this scenario, learners will practice structuring feedback using the SBI model while maintaining psychological safety and using growth-oriented language.

Success Signal:

Learner can identify effective SBI feedback, recognize how tone/framing affects relationships, and apply the model in a realistic workplace conversation.

Context:

Maya (Canadian, indirect communicator) works with Jordan (direct communicator) at a tech company. Jordan just gave a client presentation that was rushed and missed key metrics. Maya needs to give feedback.

FULL BRANCHING SCRIPT WITH DECISIONS

SLIDE 1: INTRODUCTION (Situation Setup)

Title: A Feedback Moment

Narration/Text:

"You're Maya, a project coordinator at a tech firm. Your colleague Jordan just finished presenting quarterly results to an important client. The presentation was rushed—Jordan spoke very quickly and skipped several key metrics that the client specifically asked about.

The client looked confused and asked to reschedule for more details. Your manager has asked you to give Jordan some feedback to help them improve before the next presentation.

How will you approach this conversation?"

Navigation: [Continue] → Slide 2

SLIDE 2: DECISION POINT 1 - Opening the Conversation

Title: How will you start the feedback conversation?

Prompt: "You've just caught Jordan in the break room. How do you begin?"

OPTIONS:

A) "Hey Jordan! That presentation went really well overall. You have great energy when you present. I just wanted to chat about one small thing that might help for next time."

B) "Jordan, can we talk about the client presentation? There were some issues we need to address."

C) "Jordan, you really need to slow down when you present. You're losing the audience."

Navigation:

- Option A → Slide 3A
 - Option B → Slide 3B
 - Option C → Slide 3C
-

SLIDE 3A: Consequence + Feedback (BEST CHOICE)

Dialogue Outcome:

Jordan smiles and sits down. "Sure! I thought it went okay, but I'm open to feedback. What's up?"

Feedback to Learner:

 **Correct Choice**

Why this works:

You started with a positive observation ("great energy") before transitioning to feedback. This builds psychological safety by showing you noticed Jordan's strengths first. Starting with strengths reduces defensiveness and signals that this is a growth conversation, not criticism.

Reflection Prompt:

Notice how Jordan's body language stayed open. How did leading with a positive observation help create safety for this conversation?

Cultural Insight:

Starting with genuine appreciation is effective across cultures—it shows respect and sets a collaborative tone rather than a corrective one.

Relationship Note:

Trust is building. Jordan feels safe and receptive.

Navigation: [Continue] → Slide 4

SLIDE 3B: Consequence + Feedback (PARTIAL)

Dialogue Outcome:

Jordan's smile fades slightly. "Oh... okay. What issues?" Jordan crosses their arms.

Feedback to Learner:

 **Partially Correct**

Why this is risky:

While you're being direct, the word "issues" signals problems without context. This can trigger defensiveness before you've even explained what happened. You haven't built psychological safety first.

Reflection Prompt:

How did Jordan's body language change? What might have caused them to become guarded?

Cultural Insight:

Leading with "issues" or "problems" can feel abrupt, especially for people who value relationship-building in communication. Consider starting with context or a strength first.

Relationship Note:

Trust is neutral but fragile. Jordan is listening but wary.

Navigation: [Continue] → Slide 4

SLIDE 3C: Consequence + Feedback (POOR CHOICE)

Dialogue Outcome:

Jordan looks frustrated. "What? I thought it went fine. I covered everything I needed to."

Feedback to Learner:

 **Incorrect Choice**

Why this doesn't work:

You skipped the SBI model completely and jumped straight to vague criticism ("you need to slow down"). This focuses on Jordan's behavior as a personal flaw rather than explaining the situation and impact. It also doesn't acknowledge what went well.

Reflection Prompt:

Why did Jordan react defensively? What was missing from this feedback approach?

Cultural Insight:

Blunt criticism without context can damage trust, especially when it feels like a personal attack rather than constructive feedback.

Relationship Note:

Trust is weakened. Jordan feels attacked and may shut down.

Navigation: [Continue] → Slide 4

SLIDE 4: DECISION POINT 2 - Delivering the SBI Feedback

Title: Now, structure your feedback using the SBI model

Context Text:

"You've opened the conversation. Now it's time to give the actual feedback. Remember the SBI model: Situation, Behavior, Impact."

Prompt: "Which feedback statement uses the SBI model effectively?"

OPTIONS:

A) "In this morning's client presentation, you spoke very quickly and skipped over the Q3 revenue metrics that the client specifically asked about. This made it hard for them to follow, and they asked to reschedule to get those details."

B) "You always rush through presentations. It's becoming a pattern and you really need to work on your pacing."

C) "The client seemed confused during your presentation. I think you should try to be clearer next time."

Navigation:

- Option A → Slide 5A
 - Option B → Slide 5B
 - Option C → Slide 5C
-

SLIDE 5A: Consequence + Feedback (BEST CHOICE)

Dialogue Outcome:

Jordan nods thoughtfully. "Oh, I didn't realize I skipped those metrics. I was nervous about the time limit. That makes sense why they wanted to reschedule."

Feedback to Learner:

✔ Correct Choice - Excellent SBI Application

Why this works:

You applied the full SBI model perfectly:

- **Situation:** "In this morning's client presentation"
- **Behavior:** "you spoke very quickly and skipped over the Q3 revenue metrics"
- **Impact:** "made it hard for them to follow, and they asked to reschedule"

This is specific, objective, and focuses on observable actions—not Jordan's character. Jordan can clearly understand what happened and why it mattered.

Reflection Prompt:

How did being specific about the situation and behavior help Jordan understand the feedback without feeling attacked?

Cultural Insight:

Using SBI allows you to be clear and direct while still being respectful—it bridges different communication styles by focusing on facts, not judgment.

Relationship Note:

Trust is strengthened. Jordan feels respected and understands the issue clearly.

Navigation: [Continue] → Slide 6

SLIDE 5B: Consequence + Feedback (POOR CHOICE)

Dialogue Outcome:

Jordan looks hurt. "That's not fair. I don't *always* rush. I thought I did fine today."

Feedback to Learner:

✗ Incorrect Choice

Why this doesn't work:

You used absolute language ("always") and made it about Jordan's character rather than specific behavior. This skips the SBI model completely and generalizes, which feels like an attack. There's no clear situation or measurable impact mentioned.

Reflection Prompt:

What words triggered Jordan's defensive reaction? How could you reframe this to focus on a specific instance instead of a pattern?

Cultural Insight:

Generalizations ("always," "never") undermine psychological safety and make feedback feel personal rather than constructive.

Relationship Note:

Trust is damaged. Jordan feels judged rather than supported.

Navigation: [Continue] → Slide 6

SLIDE 5C: Consequence + Feedback (PARTIAL)**Dialogue Outcome:**

Jordan looks uncertain. "Um, okay. But what specifically should I do differently?"

Feedback to Learner:

 **Partially Correct**

Why this needs improvement:

While you mentioned the impact ("client seemed confused"), you didn't specify the situation or behavior clearly. "Be clearer" is too vague—Jordan doesn't know *what* to change. You missed the opportunity to use SBI to make the feedback actionable.

Reflection Prompt:

What information is Jordan still missing? How could you make this feedback more specific using the SBI model?

Cultural Insight:

Vague feedback may feel polite, but it doesn't help the person improve. Clarity with kindness is more respectful.

Relationship Note:

Trust is neutral. Jordan wants to improve but doesn't have clear direction.

Navigation: [Continue] → Slide 6

**SLIDE 6: DECISION POINT 3 - Moving Toward Solutions
(Growth-Oriented Language)**

Title: Help Jordan move forward

Context Text:

"You've given the feedback using SBI. Now, how will you frame the path forward to maintain psychological safety and support Jordan's growth?"

Prompt: "What do you say next?"

OPTIONS:

A) "I know you care about delivering great presentations. Let's work together on a strategy for next time—maybe creating a checklist of key points to cover so you don't miss anything under time pressure."

B) "Just try to remember to include all the metrics next time. It's really important."

C) "This keeps happening, and it's affecting our client relationships. You need to fix this."

Navigation:

- Option A → Slide 7A
 - Option B → Slide 7B
 - Option C → Slide 7C
-

SLIDE 7A: Consequence + Feedback (BEST CHOICE)

Dialogue Outcome:

Jordan's face brightens. "That's a great idea! A checklist would really help me stay on track when I'm nervous. Can we work on one together?"

Feedback to Learner:

 **Correct Choice - Growth-Oriented Language**

Why this works:

You used high-impact, growth-oriented language:

- Acknowledged Jordan's positive intent ("I know you care")
- Framed feedback as collaboration ("Let's work together")
- Offered a specific, actionable solution (checklist)

This maintains psychological safety while moving toward improvement. Jordan feels supported, not blamed.

Reflection Prompt:

Which specific phrase helped Jordan feel like you're on their team rather than criticizing them?

Cultural Insight:

Collaborative language ("let's") builds trust across all cultures and shifts feedback from judgment to partnership.

Relationship Note:

Trust is fully restored and strengthened. Jordan feels motivated and supported.

Navigation: [Continue] → Slide 8 (Conclusion)

SLIDE 7B: Consequence + Feedback (PARTIAL)**Dialogue Outcome:**

Jordan nods slowly. "Yeah, okay. I'll try to remember."

Feedback to Learner:

 **Partially Correct**

Why this could be better:

While polite, this statement is too vague and puts all the responsibility on Jordan to "remember" without offering support or a concrete strategy. You missed the opportunity to collaborate and provide actionable next steps.

Reflection Prompt:

How might Jordan be feeling right now? What could you offer to make this feedback more actionable and supportive?

Cultural Insight:

Minimizing the issue ("just try") can feel dismissive and doesn't show investment in Jordan's growth.

Relationship Note:

Trust is neutral. Jordan will comply but may not feel truly supported.

Navigation: [Continue] → Slide 8 (Conclusion)

SLIDE 7C: Consequence + Feedback (POOR CHOICE)**Dialogue Outcome:**

Jordan's jaw tightens. "I said I didn't realize. I'll handle it." Jordan gets up and leaves abruptly.

Feedback to Learner:

 **Incorrect Choice**

Why this doesn't work:

You doubled down on criticism ("this keeps happening") without offering solutions or support.

This destroys psychological safety and makes Jordan feel blamed rather than helped. The relationship is now strained.

Reflection Prompt:

How did this response shut down the conversation? What impact will this have on your working relationship with Jordan?

Cultural Insight:

Harsh, repetitive criticism damages trust and discourages future openness—especially without offering help or collaboration.

Relationship Note:

Trust is broken. Jordan feels attacked and will likely avoid future feedback conversations with you.

Navigation: [Continue] → Slide 8 (Conclusion)

SLIDE 8: CONCLUSION & LEARNER TAKEAWAY

Title: What Did You Learn?

Content:

The SBI Model in Action:

You just practiced giving feedback using the **Situation-Behavior-Impact** model. Here's what makes feedback effective:

1. Social-Emotional Competency

Recognize emotions (yours and theirs) and create psychological safety before delivering feedback.

2. Cultural Fluency

Adapt your communication style to be clear AND respectful, bridging different preferences for directness.

3. Language for Impact

Use growth-oriented phrases like:

- "Here's what went well and what we can improve"
- "Let's work together on..."
- "I know you care about..."

4. Relationship Building

Feedback delivered with respect and collaboration strengthens trust—feedback delivered with judgment damages it.

Reflection Questions:

- How did your choices affect Jordan's willingness to receive feedback?
- Which phrases built psychological safety, and which undermined it?
- How might you adapt your approach when giving feedback to someone with a different communication style?

Next Steps:

Use the Feedback Prep Worksheet to plan a real feedback conversation this week. Choose a peer you trust and practice the SBI model.

Navigation: [Complete] → End / LMS Tracking

CONSEQUENCE MATRIX (Quick Reference)

Decision Point	Choice A (Best)	Choice B (Partial)	Choice C (Poor)
1. Opening	Positive + safety	Direct but cold	Blunt criticism
Outcome	Trust builds	Trust neutral/wary	Trust weakened
2. SBI Delivery	Full SBI model	Vague generalization	Too general/unclear
Outcome	Understanding + respect	Defensive reaction	Confusion/unclear
3. Growth Language	Collaborative + solution	Vague reminder	Harsh + blame
Outcome	Motivated + supported	Compliant but unsupported	Trust broken

VARIABLES & SCORING (for SCORM)

Tracking Variables:

- `decision1_choice` (A/B/C)
- `decision2_choice` (A/B/C)
- `decision3_choice` (A/B/C)
- `total_score` (calculated)

Scoring Logic:

- Choice A = 10 points
- Choice B = 5 points
- Choice C = 0 points

Passing Score: 20/30 (66%)

Completion Trigger: Reaching Slide 8

